Appendix: Provider Qualification under Section 1 of the Code of Practice on Transparency of AI-Generated Content

Scruple — Docent LLC (dba Docent Technologies)

2026-07-16

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Applicant (legal entity)	Docent LLC (dba Docent Technologies)
Brand covered	Scruple
Public product site	`scruple.ai`
Signatory of record	Shaun Hargadine
Contact	`scruple@docentechs.com`
Date	2026-07-16

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1. Basis for signature

The Applicant signs Section 1 in two capacities, both provided for in the Section's "Commitments" opening:

1. **Third-party provider of marking and detection solutions.** The load-bearing signature basis. The Applicant provides C2PA-based marking, imperceptible watermarking, and detection tooling that downstream providers of generative AI systems consume in order to satisfy their own Article 50(2) and (5) obligations. Per the Code, commitments apply to "the Signatory's … marking and detection solution as appropriate."
2. **Provider of a generative AI system.** The Applicant operates its own generative AI system, Scruple Studio, in which third-party base models are deployed under the Applicant's own name. For outputs of that system placed on the Union market, the Applicant holds the ordinary Article 50(2) provider responsibility per Article 3(3).

The Scruple substrate was originally designed as tamper-proof cryptographic provenance and attestation infrastructure for AI content. The Code's transparency measures are produced natively by that substrate rather than layered on top of it.

2. Systems covered (Article 50(2) provider capacity)

Scruple Studio (`scruple.ai`) is the Applicant's own generative AI system. It deploys third-party image, video, and fine-tune model families under a common interface. Every output generated by Scruple Studio carries the full marking stack described in §4, exercised through the Applicant's own marking and detection solutions.

Base-model authorship remains with the respective upstream providers; the Applicant's Article 3(3) responsibility is limited to the system into which those models are deployed.

3. Marking and detection solutions covered (Section 1 third-party solution vendor capacity)

The following are the Scruple-provided marking and detection solutions to which this signature applies:

- **Scruple Witness API** (`witness.scruple.ai`) — a programmatic surface that receives cryptographic hashes of AI-generated content from downstream providers, returns a C2PA-conformant signed manifest (Sub-measure 1.1.1), and records an append-only audit-chain leaf (Sub-measure 1.1.3, optional).
- **Scruple Watermark Reference** — an open-source imperceptible watermarking module for raster image outputs (Sub-measure 1.1.2).
- **Scruple integration plugins** — first-party embeddable plugins for widely-used creative applications that apply the marking stack at the moment of generation inside the host application.
- **Scruple-Verify** (`scruple-verify`, open-source) — the detection solution, distributed as a library and CLI, with a planned public HTTPS detection endpoint.

4. Sub-measure coverage

Layer	Code text	Modality	Status	Solution
1.1.1	Digitally signed metadata	Image, video, audio, PDF, ML models	Shipped	C2PA v2.x manifest signed with ES256 (P-256 ECDSA); signing key held in a hardware-attested Trusted Execution Environment (AMD SEV-SNP CVM with PKCS#11 HSM); certificates issued by a Program-designated C2PA Trust List CA (enrollment pending)
1.1.2	Imperceptible watermark	Raster image outputs of Scruple Studio and of downstream products consuming the Scruple Watermark Reference	Shipped	Classical DCT-domain spread-spectrum watermark with Reed-Solomon error correction; 128-bit payload
1.1.2	Imperceptible watermark	Video outputs	Roadmap Q4 2026	Per-frame image-watermark extension
1.1.2	Imperceptible watermark	Audio outputs	Roadmap Q4 2026	Frequency-domain watermark
1.1.2	Imperceptible watermark	Free-form text	Not currently produced as a Scruple output	If added, planned integration of an open-source text-watermarking technique

Layer	Code text	Modality	Status	Solution
1.1.3	Fingerprinting or logging *(optional)*	All modalities	Shipped	Append-only cryptographic audit log with Merkle-chained leaves; roots anchored to a public ledger on a fixed cadence; applied only to output data, in a secure and privacy-preserving manner

For Sub-measure 1.2 (non-removal of markings), the Applicant retains existing metadata markings on ingested content, prohibits downstream removal in its terms of service and integration documentation, and does not place any tool intended to circumvent AI-transparency markings on the market.

5. Detection solution (Commitment 2)

The detection solution is `scruple-verify`, published under an open-source license and distributed as:

- a public specification (documented in the Applicant's public source repository),
- a portable software library and CLI usable on general-purpose devices,
- a planned public HTTPS endpoint.

The solution includes a detection mechanism for each marking technique in §4 and is provided **free of charge**. It is **zero-retention** on content submitted, in line with Sub-measure 2.1.3. Detection results are downloadable in a digitally signed form including a hash of the submitted content, an identifier of the detection solution, and a timestamp, per Sub-measure 2.1.2.

Detection results are presented in a clear, distinguishable manner per Measure 2.3, and indicate whether the result is based on a metadata marking, a watermark marking, or an audit-chain lookup.

6. Deployment contexts

Context	Description
Public SaaS	`scruple.ai` — the Applicant's own generative AI system
Public marking API	`witness.scruple.ai` — third-party providers apply Scruple's marking solution to their own outputs

Context	Description
Embedded plugins	Scruple plugins hosted inside third-party creative applications, marking at the moment of generation
Single-tenant deployments	Scruple substrate deployed on a customer's own infrastructure under the same marking regime

All Union-facing deployment contexts apply the same marking stack described in §4.

7. Interoperability (Measure 3.4)

The Sub-measure 1.1.1 layer already implements a recognised open standard (C2PA v2.x) whose manifest engine is also adopted by JPEG Trust (ISO/IEC 21617-1:2025), satisfying the initial-stage interoperability requirement under Measure 3.4(a).

For the **2 February 2027** cross-signatory detection interoperability deadline (Measure 3.4(c)), the Applicant commits to implementing at least one of the enumerated interoperability options and will report its chosen approach to the AI Office in advance of that deadline. The planned public detection endpoint is designed to be reachable via a publicly readable signpost in the C2PA manifest.

8. SME/SMC proportionality (Recital (g), Measure 4.1, Measure 4.3)

The Applicant has fewer than 10 personnel and turnover well under the SME threshold. Section 1's SME/SMC proportionality clause applies. This document is scaled to that proportionality — a concise, structured qualification rather than a heavier compliance surface.

9. What this signature does NOT cover

- The Applicant does not train or provide a general-purpose AI model under its own name; base-model provider responsibility remains with the respective upstream providers.
- Downstream providers who consume the Scruple Witness API or the Scruple Watermark Reference and have not themselves signed the Code remain independently responsible for their own Article 50(2) and (5) compliance. This signature covers the Applicant's own marking and detection solutions; it does not extend to those providers' compliance posture generally.
- The Applicant does not currently operate a deepfake-focused product. If such a product is added, this qualification will be supplemented.

10. Reference contact

Signatory of record	Shaun Hargadine, Docent LLC (dba Docent Technologies)
Correspondence	`scruple@docentechs.com`
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